

HOUSE BILL 2438

By McKenzie

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15,
Chapter 2, relative to "Gold Star Father's Day."

WHEREAS, November 9 is the day for observance of "Gold Star Father's Day" to honor the fathers of fallen or permanently disabled members of the United States Armed Forces and to celebrate and honor such fathers and their child's sacrifice; and

WHEREAS, the goals of "Gold Star Father's Day" on November 9, are to honor and celebrate fathers who have lost children in service to the United States; to honor fathers of fallen members of the Armed Forces and recognize that they, as parents, have experienced extraordinary and unimaginable loss; to recognize the need to support families of members of the Armed Forces throughout the United States; and to honor the courage of fathers who understand the true price of freedom and now face Father's Day without their child or children; and

WHEREAS, thousands of men and women have laid down their lives to defend the liberty and soul of our nation, and families of such fallen members of the United States Armed Forces have lost their loved ones in service to our country; and

WHEREAS, families of members of the Armed Forces demonstrate a unique kind of heroism that includes supporting children and family members while loved ones are deployed, sacrificing holidays with members who are serving overseas, and facing each day knowing their loved one might be in danger and may never return home; and

WHEREAS, before the Iraq war, the United States lost over 1,300,000 members of the Armed Forces during wartime, and, since October 2001, over 4,400 members of the Armed Forces have lost their lives serving this country, leaving thousands of grieving family members behind; and

WHEREAS, in 1936, Congress designated the last Sunday in September as Gold Star Mother's Day; and

WHEREAS, in 2015, the Gold Star Father's Act was signed into law to ensure Gold Star Fathers were eligible for the same benefits guaranteed to mothers of fallen or permanently disabled members of the Armed Forces to recognize their sacrifice and loss. However, the Act did not designate a Gold Star Father's Day; and

WHEREAS, President Joseph R. Biden, Jr., designated September 25, 2022, as Gold Star Mother's and Family Day, President Donald Trump designated September 24, 2017, as Gold Star Mother's and Family Day, and President Barack Obama proclaimed September 25, 2016, as Gold Star Mother's and Family Day; and

WHEREAS, on March 24, 2017, the Georgia House of Representatives adopted House Resolution 723, recognizing November 9, as Georgia Gold Star Father's Day; and

WHEREAS, on March 6, 2025, the Mississippi House of Representatives adopted House Concurrent Resolution 48, recognizing November 9, as Mississippi Gold Star Father's Day; and

WHEREAS, it is important that the members of this legislative body also honor the fathers of those who made the ultimate sacrifice in service to our country; now, therefore,
BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15, Chapter 2, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

November 9 of each year is to be observed as "Gold Star Father's Day," to honor and recognize fathers who have lost children in service to the United States as members of the United States armed forces. This day shall not be a legal holiday as defined in § 15-1-101.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.